

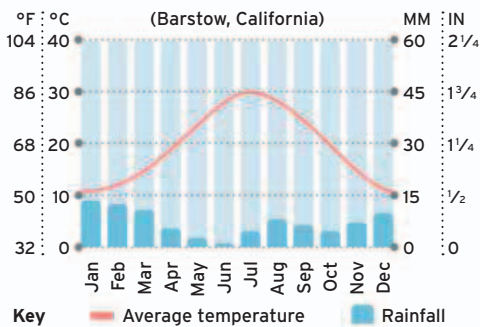
LOCATION

The Mojave Desert lies between the Sonoran and Great Basin deserts, mostly in southeastern California.



CLIMATE

The Mojave Desert receives less than 13 in (330 mm) of rain a year and some areas get none at all. Temperatures vary enormously.



Kit fox

Vulpes macrotis



Thanks to its huge ears, the kit fox has excellent hearing, which helps it locate prey ranging from insects to jackrabbits and lizards. Oversized ears also keep this desert dweller cool by thermoregulation: their huge surface area releases large amounts of heat during the hottest months, keeping the animal's body temperature within comfortable limits.

Survival skills

North America's smallest wild canid has other desert survival skills. The soles of its feet are fur-lined, lending traction but also keeping the pads from burning on hot terrain. Mainly nocturnal, the kit fox avoids the heat as well as predators, such as coyotes, by spending the day inside one of many burrows that it either digs or takes over from animals such as prairie dogs. It also makes dens in manmade structures such as storm drains.

Kit foxes are mainly monogamous, but pairs do not necessarily share the same den and they always hunt alone. A female bears an average of four young per litter, which stay with her for five to six months.

↔ 18-22 in (46-56 cm)

⚖ 4-6 lb (1.8-2.7 kg)

⊗ Common

🐭 Rodents, hares, insects

🏠

SW. North America

Kit foxes rarely drink, obtaining moisture from their food

▽ **CHANGING COAT**
The kit fox sports a rusty-tan to buff gray coat in the summer. It takes on a silvery gray hue in the winter.



AVOIDING THE HEAT
Red spotted toads lie dormant underground in dry periods, but after rain falls, they emerge by the thousands in the cool of the night. Females lay their eggs in small, temporary pools. They hatch in three days, and the tadpoles quickly develop into toads.

rainfall of 7 in (178mm)

RED SPOTTED TOAD